were engaged along the former cease-fire line. Pakistan's "Operation Gibraltar," launched late in July at Bhutto's urgent insistence, proved a disaster. Most of Pakistan's infiltrators over the high-altitude line froze to death before Ayub's "Operation Grand Slam" could deliver its knockout blow against Jammu from Sialkot, hoping to capture Akhnur and thus cut the only rail link from India to Kashmir. India's strategic planners were much wiser than Ayub and Bhutto, opening the floodgates of their nearest dams and trapping Pakistan's tank corps in deep mud, then launching a three-pronged attack across the Indo-Pakistani international border in Punjab, aimed at the defenseless capital of Lahore. Bhutto had assured Ayub that this could never happen, saying he was positive that Shastri would never dare to attack Lahore. Now Ayub was faced with the most humiliating defeat of his life as India's tanks rolled into sight of his greatest city's Mughal Fort and Shalimar Gardens. It was his worst nightmare come true, and, in desperation, he phoned U.S. President Lyndon Johnson, begging him to arrange an immediate cease-fire with India.

Johnson froze all U.S. shipments of arms and ammunition to South Asia, and then spoke with Russia's Premier Alexei Kosygin, who invited Ayub and Shastri to Tashkent in Central Asia for a peace conference.

They met on 4 January 1966, and India's shortest leader and Pakistan's tallest, South Asia's David and Goliath, soon learned to like and respect each other. "Instead of fighting each other, let us start fighting poverty, disease and ignorance,"[4] Shastri urged Ayub that first day, and Ayub nodded agreement. Bhutto, who was there at Ayub's side, frowned and sank lower in his seat, angrily sulking as he watched Ayub respond with warm approval to everything Shastri said. Ayub was most relieved that Shastri agreed to return to India's prewar borders without insisting on any humiliating concessions from Pakistan. When the conference ended on 10 January, Ayub and Shastri shook hands warmly and signed their agreement with smiles on both faces. Bhutto glowered and withdrew scowling, then muttered that Ayub had "betrayed" Pakistan, "abandoning its just claims to Kashmir."

Immediately after this peace conference, Shastri's frail heart gave out in frozen Tashkent, and none of his doctors could resuscitate him. Awakened by his own aide and told, "The bastard is dead," Bhutto characteristically replied, "Which one?"[5]

Ayub helped carry Shastri's coffin to the plane that flew his body home. Bhutto continued to view Ayub, who had brought him into the